

Bro Science Became Modern Science

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Executive Summary

A self-improvement community member recounts how practices once mocked as conspiracy theories or bro science — copper cups, raw milk, no-fap, grounding, avoiding chlorine and plastics — are now entering mainstream discourse, claiming the industry was a decade ahead.

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The "10 Years Ahead" Claim 0:00

- A member of the speaker's community based in the Netherlands — described as "very, very successful" — sparked this reflection during a call
 - He noted that 5–8 years ago, the self-improvement industry was discussing topics that were labeled conspiracies at the time
 - His core observation: "us guys in this industry, we were like 10 years ahead of everybody"
- The speaker agrees, pointing to how these once-fringe ideas are now appearing in mainstream documentaries
 - Example topics now going mainstream: dangers of plastics, the type of underwear men wear, grounding/earthing

Practices Once Called Conspiracies 0:24

- The community was ridiculed for promoting a range of health and lifestyle practices that are now gaining wider acceptance:
 - **Copper cups** for ionizing water
 - Avoiding **chlorinated pools** in favor of fresh water
 - Adding copper to water filters
 - Drinking **raw milk** and eating meat-heavy diets
 - Looksmxing (optimizing physical appearance)

- These were collectively dismissed as "bro science" — a term many remember from Reddit-era debates
- The speaker references a now-mainstream documentary focus on **avoiding plastics** and choosing specific types of boxer shorts as evidence the mainstream has caught up

No-Fap and the OG Influencers 1:09

- The speaker credits **Shawn Russell** as one of the original voices promoting no-fap and cold showers
 - Russell ran a blog called "**Men Provement**" in the early days of the self-improvement space
 - Described as "one of the OGs" and "one of the Gs, man" — the speaker explicitly says he doesn't want the industry to forget him
 - Russell was unable to successfully transition to YouTube, which limited his wider recognition despite being an early pioneer
- **Hamza** is also mentioned as an early advocate — specifically for not wearing conventional boxer shorts and choosing a particular type of underwear, which the speaker recalls as an early video topic
- The speaker briefly references a video he made about **clavicular** appearance, noting that one subject of discussion "looks unbelievable" compared to before — citing good skin and high cheekbones as visible results of the lifestyle

Grounding and Barefoot Walking 1:54

- The speaker personally practices **walking barefoot** as much as possible and uses specific walking techniques
 - Demonstrates a walking style: one foot directly in front of the other (a deliberate, aligned gait)
- He has installed natural ground covering at his house for this purpose
 - Two stated reasons: aesthetic improvement to the space, and the ability to walk on it barefoot
 - He describes walking on it in the morning when the sun is out — "it smells so nice" and evokes a feeling of being in the woods
- This is framed as "**grounding**" (also called earthing) — reconnecting with the earth — which he says "a generation has rediscovered"
- His point: the self-improvement community was doing this long before it became a recognized wellness concept

Challenging Medical Establishment Views 2:41

- The speaker recounts a personal anecdote involving his father's diagnosis:
 - Doctors told him his father had **testicular and prostate cancer** and attributed it to testosterone being "too high"
 - The speaker rejected this reasoning: "That's bollocks, because when he was 18 his testosterone would have been even higher"
 - His implication: high testosterone is natural and was not the cause — the medical framing was flawed

- This is used as a broader illustration of his distrust of mainstream medical advice and his belief that the self-improvement community has held correct, evidence-based instincts that conventional medicine has been slow to recognize

"We were ahead of our time. We were doing all this stuff... and the world's finally catching up with us."